INTRODUCTION · ALL DOMAINS

Start Here

Claude Certified Developer – Foundations: what the exam tests, how this course is built, the route through it, and how to study so the time pays off.

VIDEOS 37 RUNTIME about 9 h 13 min QUESTIONS 269, all original

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This exam rarely asks what a feature is. It asks which of four real features fits the situation in front of you.

The exam in one slide

	DETAIL
Questions	53, multiple choice and multiple response; each says how many to pick
Time and pass mark	120 minutes; scaled score of 720 on 100 to 1,000
Delivery and fee	Pearson VUE, online or test centre; USD 125
Validity	12 months from the date you earn it
Languages	English and Japanese
Who can sit it	Claude Partner Network organisations; partner email; 18 or over

CURRENCY CHECK

Guide version 1.0, effective July 2026. Re-checked on 25 Oct 2026: unchanged.

Who this exam is for

- **Engineers who build with Claude:** AI and ML engineers, tech leads, senior software engineers.
- **The job tested:** turning business requirements into working Claude systems.
- **Suggested background:** 1-5 years of engineering, 6+ months hands-on with Claude or similar.
- **Languages:** Python and/or TypeScript; REST APIs and command-line tools.
- **Not for:** non-technical users, or roles that only write prompts.

> ON THE EXAM
>
> It tests building decisions, not syntax. Code appears in this course so you recognise it, never to be memorised.

Eight domains, unequal weights

DOMAIN	WEIGHT	TAUGHT IN
D2 Applications and Integration	33.1%	03-04, 09-17
D5 Model Selection and Optimisation	16.8%	02, 06, 18-19
D1 Agents and Workflows	14.7%	23-26
D6 Prompt and Context Engineering	11.0%	05, 07-08
D8 Tools and MCPs	10.6%	20-22
D7 Security and Safety	8.1%	28-29
D3 Claude Code / D4 Debugging	3.1% / 2.6%	27 / 30

ON THE EXAM

A third of the marks are Applications and Integration. Half are that plus model selection.

How this course was built

- **The official guide sets the structure:** every domain and sub-objective, at its weight.
- **A practice bank set the emphasis only.** None of its questions appears here.
- **Every question is new:** 216 worked scenarios and 53 practice-paper questions.
- **Facts come from Anthropic's documentation,** checked and dated as each module was written.
- **Ten decision rules** explain most right answers. Module 01 introduces them.

> WHY IT MATTERS
>
> Recycled questions teach you to remember answers. New ones teach you to decide.

Already changed since the guide

- **Models:** the 5.5 family, with thinking on by default and effort as the main dial.
- **API version 2026-10-21:** temperature, top_p and top_k now return an error.
- **MCP 2026-07-28:** a stateless protocol; standard transports stdio and Streamable HTTP.
- **Claude Code:** auto mode by default; custom commands merged into Skills.
- **Newest:** Claude Models on Google Cloud, run by Anthropic (22 Oct 2026).

> CURRENCY CHECK
>
> Answer with the principle; treat version details as currency checks. Module 32 has the full, dated list.

Meet Copperlet, our running example

THE COMPANY

Lettings software, fictional

- UK software for letting agents, landlords and tenants
- 310,000 tenancies; 60 engineers in 8 squads
- Seven Claude features, from chat to agents
- One customer that must use Amazon Bedrock

THE PROBLEMS

Sixteen planted mistakes

- A prompt copied into eleven files
- One API key in every environment
- "Just lower the temperature"
- Each one diagnosed and fixed along the way

WHY IT HELPS

Copperlet is invented. Its mistakes are the ones real teams make, and the exam tests.

How every module works

01
Core idea
One picture to hang the module on.

02
Teach
Slides, code you will recognise, callouts for the exam.

03
Scenarios
Pause, commit to an answer, then watch it worked.

04
Signal
The clue in the question that decides it.

05
Five lines
The whole module, in five lines.

THE HABIT

Watching a worked scenario without answering first teaches almost nothing. Pause and commit.

The route, part 1

PART	MODULES	RUNTIME
Start	01 The Claude Developer: the exam, the platform, ten rules	19 min
Part 1 - Foundations	02-04 Generation, the Messages API, SDKs	50 min
Part 2 - Prompts, output, context	05-08 Prompts, thinking and effort, output, context	1 h 06
Part 3 - Building the application	09-17 Requirements to life cycle: nine modules	2 h 08
Part 4 - Models and cost	18-19 Choosing the model; cost and tokens	30 min

THE ROUTE

Part 3 is the longest by design. It is a third of the exam.

The route, part 2

PART	MODULES	RUNTIME
Part 5 - Tools and MCP	20-22 Tool use, MCP servers, choosing an extension	44 min
Part 6 - Agents	23-26 Workflows, subagents, the Agent SDK, patterns	54 min
Parts 7 to 9	27 Claude Code; 28-29 Security; 30 Debugging	53 min
Part 10 - Review	31-33 Confusion pairs, what changed, question craft	40 min
Practice papers	34-36 Three papers: 53 questions, a full sitting	1 h 03

THE ROUTE

Measured total for modules 01 to 36: 9 h 06 min. With this introduction, about 9 h 13 min.

A study route that works

- **Watch in order.** Later modules lean on earlier vocabulary.
- **Take practice paper 1 straight after module 33,** under exam pace.
- **Rewatch only the domain where misses cluster,** then take paper 2 a day later.
- **Space papers out,** so each tests recall, not short-term memory.
- **Beware comfortable revision:** rewatching what you know feels productive and moves nothing.

> THE HABIT
>
> Where your misses cluster matters more than your score. Spend your time there.

Start here, in five lines

- **The exam:** 53 questions, 120 minutes, scaled 720 to pass.
- **The weights:** a third Applications and Integration; half with model selection.
- **The method:** pause, commit, then learn the signal that decided it.
- **The currency rule:** answer with the principle; versions are checks.
- **The route:** 36 modules in ten parts, then three practice papers.

COMING UP

Next: module 01 - the Claude developer, the platform on one page, and the ten rules.